



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

6.b) How does the Heath-Carter method improve upon Sheldon's original somatotype theory? (15 Marks)

Somatotype is the expression of the body physique based on certain quantitative, measurable characters.

Limitations of sheldon's somatotype

- ① Focussed ~~only~~ only 5 physical features like → head, thoracic trunk, spinal trunk, foot, shoulder, etc.
- ② It is eucentric → done on the whites of 10-40 age group.
- ③ It was based on photographic method
- ④ It can't be generalised and it lacks the holistic approach.
- ⑤ Didn't factor the environmental aspect.
- ⑥ Gave the universal type (1-7) only.

However, the Heath and Carter method is better and improved

It takes into anthrometric measurement of 10 bodily features like

- ① Height
- ② weight
- ③ Femur biep Condyl Circumference
- ④ Humerous biep Condyl Circumference
- ⑤ Calf diameter
- ⑥ Mid- upper arm diameter.
- ⑦ Tricep skinfold
- ⑧ Calf skinfold
- ⑨ Sub-scapular skinfold
- ⑩ Supra-Spinal skinfold.

Heath and Carter divided into 3 body type with real-time measurement

- ① Endomorphic (0.5-16) : → Viscerobonic
 ↳ relaxed, comfort seeking
 ↳ fat, bro and extrovert.

(ii) Mesomorphic (1-7) $\rightarrow$ Somatotonic
 $\rightarrow$ lean & fit; aggressive, active
 and competitive.

(iii) Ectomorphic (no maxima & Minima)
 $\rightarrow$ linear & thin (+) cerebrotonic
 $\rightarrow$ intelligent, introvert and smart.

The features of Heath & Carter

- ① Gave the real-time measurement.
- ② did not only focus on the photography.
- ③ It works on the principle of Continuum or gradualness of the body type.
- ④ helps in the generalisation.

Thus, we can see the Heath and Carter method as the improved one.